Chapter 2: The Second Waking

The morning after the long night, he knows what woke him: bat droppings, dripping water and the green Revonite in the cave. In Chapter 2 he turns that into science. He makes fire, bakes clay pots, takes saltpetre and Revonite from deep under the mountain, and brews a revival fluid. By nightfall a second human being is breathing, and the two of them have to get through the night together.

"Guano, water, the green stone, and time. If that woke me, it can wake someone else."

STORY Revive the first person

MAP The same valley, opened up

START Carries on from the Chapter 1 save

NEXT Your changes, then building

One day and one night, about the length of Chapter 1: ten story steps, three new places, and a handful of new things to make. Everything marked **NEW** is something Chapter 2 adds.

THE STORY

Ten steps from dawn to dawn

DAWN

1 A new morning

The Elder Tree, then back to the Awakening Cave

He wakes in the shelter and works out what happened to him. The goal: go back to the Revonite vein in the cave. Behind it he feels a cold draught from a crack. The cave goes deeper, but it is pitch dark in there. He needs light.

MORNING

2 Fire

A camp by the pond in the clearing

Build a fire pit from stones and sticks (with E, like the shelter parts), then light it with a bow drill: the bow he already has, a stick, and dry plant fibre for tinder. Hold E and keep the rhythm until it smokes and catches. From now on the fire has to be fed.

FIELD NOTES Fire: friction, heat, tinder, flame.

MORNING

3 Clay NEW PLACE

The Clay Banks, where the pond's stream runs into the river

Dig grey clay from the bank with a digging stick (a stick shaped with the flint blade). Back at the fire, shape three pots and leave them to bake in the embers while you carry on.

FIELD NOTES Clay and fire: why baked clay holds water.

LATE MORNING

4 Torches

The Elder Tree, then the fire

Cut resin from the Elder Tree's bark, wrap it in plant fibre on a stick, and light it at the fire. A torch burns for about three minutes, so carry spares.

MIDDAY

5 The Nitre Galleries NEW PLACE

Under the southern mountain, through the crack behind the cave chamber

Torch in hand, squeeze through into two or three dark chambers. Scrape the white nitre crust off the walls (6) and chip shards from the Revonite vein (3). The bats roost in here: startle them and they pour past you, and your torch gutters. The green glow of the vein shows the way.

AFTERNOON

6 Saltpetre

The camp fire

Soak the nitre crust in a pot of water from the pond, pour it through wood ash from the fire, and boil it down. White crystals of saltpetre are left at the bottom.

FIELD NOTES Saltpetre: how it was really made, by hand, for hundreds of years.

AFTERNOON

7 The revival fluid

The camp fire

Grind the Revonite shards with a stone, stir them into saltpetre water in a baked pot, and warm it by the fire. It makes one dose.

FIELD NOTES The revival fluid: which parts are real chemistry and which part (Revonite) is invented, as in Chapter 1.

LATE AFTERNOON

8 Who first?

The statue you choose

One dose, one person. Carry the pot to them and pour. The cracks glow green and the stone falls away, just as it did for him. A first breath, a collapse, first words.

DUSK TO NIGHT

9 The second night

The clearing, then the Elder Tree

The woken person is weak and walks slowly. Get them to the Elder Tree before dark, with firewood for a second fire at its foot. In the night the bear comes, drawn by the food. Keep the fire high to hold it off, and drive it away with a torch or arrows if it comes close. Survive until dawn.

FIELD NOTES The bear: why fire keeps animals away.

DAWN

10 What they saw NEW PLACE

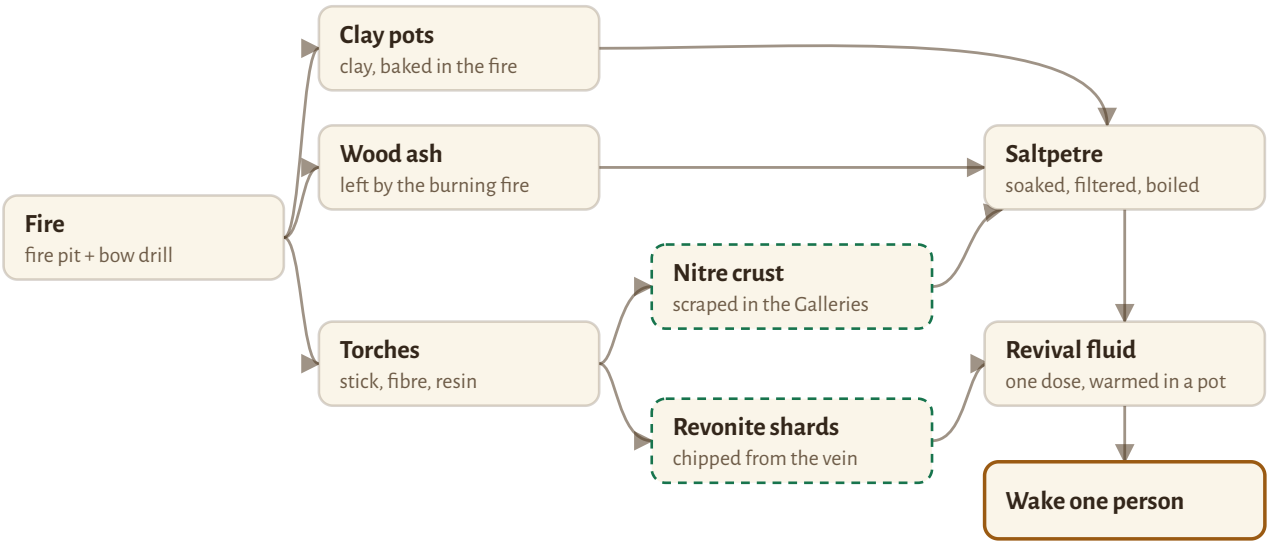
The fire, then (optionally) the Lookout on the eastern mountains

Their first real conversation: what the woken person remembers of the day of the green light. If you climb the goat trail to the Lookout, you see what lies beyond the valley, and that sets up Chapter 3. Chapter 2 is complete.

THE SCIENCE

What leads to what

The steps above as a chain, Dr. Stone style. Each thing unlocks the next, so the player always knows why they are making it. The Field Notes' "Road to Morning" page would show this chain for Chapter 2.



Dashed boxes are found in the new Nitre Galleries.

THE VALLEY, OPENED UP

Three new places, inside today's map

Everything new fits inside the current edges of the valley, so the view distance and the performance work from Chapter 1 still hold. With the tiger dead, the gorge is open: the cave to the Elder Tree is about 440 m, two minutes at a jog or one at a sprint. That is why the day's camp sits in the middle, by the pond.



● Chapter 1 zone ● New in Chapter 2

▲ Camp fire (day: clearing; night: Elder Tree)

PLACE	WHAT IS THERE
8 Clay Banks NEW	Grey clay in the bank where the stream meets the river, reeds, the sound of the water. Reached along the stream from the pond.
9 Nitre Galleries NEW	Two or three dark chambers behind the cave's back wall: white nitre crust, the big Revonite vein, the bat roost, a dead end or two. Torchlight only.
10 Lookout NEW	A ledge high on the eastern mountains, up a goat trail from Flint Rise. The first view out of the valley; the last scene of the chapter.
1 Cave changed	A crack opens behind the Revonite vein, with a cold draught.
3 Clearing changed	The day camp: fire pit, pots baking, the work of the chapter.
7 Elder Tree changed	Resin on the bark; a second fire at its foot for the night.

THE KIT

New things to make or find

All of them save on pickup like Chapter 1's things, and the ones made at the fire get a third tab in the kit, **At the fire**, next to Make and Build.

THING	HOW YOU GET IT	NEEDS	USED FOR
Fire pit	Built at a camp spot with E	8 stones, 4 sticks	Everything made with fire
Lit fire	Bow drill: hold E and keep the rhythm	The bow, 1 stick, 2 plant fibre	Light, warmth, keeping the bear off
Firewood	Sticks and branches; the fire eats one about every minute	Sticks or branches	Keeping the fire alive
Digging stick	Kit	1 stick, uses the flint blade	Digging clay
Clay	Dig at the Clay Banks with E	Digging stick	Pots
Clay pot	Shape at the fire, then it bakes for two game hours	2 clay	Water, boiling, the fluid
Pot of water	Fill a pot at the pond or the stream with E	An empty pot	Saltpetre
Resin	Cut from the Elder Tree's bark with E	Flint blade	Torches
Torch	Kit, then lit at the fire; about 3 minutes each	1 stick, 1 plant fibre, 1 resin	Light in the Galleries
Wood ash	Builds up in a burning fire; scoop it with E	—	Saltpetre
Nitre crust	Scrape the gallery walls with E	Flint blade, a lit torch	Saltpetre

THING	HOW YOU GET IT	NEEDS	USED FOR
Revonite shard	Chip the green vein with E	A stone, a lit torch	The fluid
Saltpetre	At the fire	6 nitre crust, 1 wood ash, a pot of water	The fluid
Revival fluid	At the fire	2 saltpetre, 3 Revonite shards, a baked pot	Waking one person

UNDER THE HOOD

What has to be built

Fire and its light

A fire pit with fuel that burns down, flames, embers and smoke. At night it lights the ground and the people around it.

The light is worked out in the shaders, like the cave's green glow, not with a real lamp: a real light costs every pixel on screen every frame, which is what overheated your Mac before.

The torch

Held like the blade (a fourth slot). Lights a pool around the hero in the dark and burns out; the Galleries are lit only by torches and the Revonite.

Same shader light as the fire, following the hand.

Working at the fire

A kit tab for things that need a fire nearby. Slow ones (baking pots, boiling) carry on while you do something else, with a timer shown over the fire.

Builds on the kit's Make and Build tabs.

The Nitre Galleries

Two or three chambers joined to the cave, white crust on the walls, the bat roost, a dead end or two.

Carved the same way as the cave, so the join is seamless; the bats already exist.

The waking

The chosen statue is swapped for a living body in the same pose. Green light runs through the cracks, the stone shell falls away, and the person breathes, stumbles and speaks.

The hero's own awakening effect, run on someone else.

The companion

Walks after you (slowly at first), sits by the fire, climbs into the shelter, and speaks short lines at story moments. Not a fighter in this chapter.

The statues' avatars and animations, the hero's walking.

The night raid

The bear, drawn by food at the camp, circles in the dark and comes in when the fire burns low. Torches and arrows drive it off.

The existing bear and combat.

Saves and the title

Chapter 2 starts from the Chapter 1 save. The title shows “Continue: Chapter 2”, and Chapter 1 stays replayable.

The autosave added this week.

FIELD NOTES

The explaining, Dr. Stone style

The Field Notes get new pages: Fire, Clay and fire, Saltpetre, The revival fluid, The bear, and a page for the person who wakes. In Chapter 1 the hero explains things to himself. Once someone wakes, the speech bubbles become a conversation: he explains, they ask, and sometimes they know something he does not.

THE BIG CHOICE

Who wakes first

Three of the people of stone from Chapter 1. One is picked for the story; the plan recommends the first.

RECOMMENDED

The runner by the cave

“He was running for the cave. Toward me. He didn’t make it.”

Why was he running to the cave? Maybe he knew something about it, or about the light. That question carries straight into Chapter 3. He stands near the cave, so the scene happens close to where the fluid is made.

The mother

“A mother and her child. Hand in hand.”

The strongest feeling. With one dose, the child stays stone for now, which gives Chapter 3 a powerful reason to make more fluid. It is also the heaviest choice for a player.

The woman pointing at the sky

“She’s pointing at the sky. They all looked up. What did they see?”

She saw where the light came from, so she can point the way out of the valley for Chapter 3.

BUILDING IT

In this order

Each phase ends with something you can play and try. Sizes are relative to each other.

1. Fire, its light, the torch and the “At the fire” kit tab LARGE

2. The Clay Banks, digging, pots, carrying water MEDIUM
3. The Nitre Galleries, the bats, nitre and Revonite LARGE
4. Saltpetre, the revival fluid, and the objectives for steps 1–7 MEDIUM
5. The waking scene and the companion LARGE
6. The second night: the escort, the bear raid, firewood MEDIUM
7. Field Notes pages, the conversation, the Lookout ending MEDIUM
8. A full playthrough on your Mac: smoothness, saves, nothing confusing MEDIUM

YOUR TURN

Questions for you

1. Who wakes first: the runner, the mother, or the woman pointing at the sky?
   Recommended: the runner.
2. Is "The Second Waking" the right title? The Chapter 1 end screen currently promises "Chapter 2: The Stone Road"; that name would suit Chapter 3, the journey out.
   Recommended: The Second Waking now, The Stone Road for Chapter 3.
3. Camp: the day's fire by the pond and the night at the Elder Tree, or everything at the Elder Tree?
   Recommended: by the pond for the day (shorter walks), the Elder Tree for the night.
4. The bow drill: a short hold-and-rhythm moment, or a simple timed action like the others?
   Recommended: the rhythm moment; it is the chapter's first big achievement.
5. Fishing at the Clay Banks: in this chapter, or later?
   Recommended: later, to keep this chapter focused.
6. The Lookout ending: in this chapter, or saved for Chapter 3?
   Recommended: in this chapter, as the last scene.
7. Anything to cut, add or change in the ten steps?

> Reply in the chat with your answers, for example "1 runner, 2 yes, 3 pond, 4 rhythm, 5 later, 6 yes", plus any changes. I'll update this plan, and start building phase 1 once you're happy with it.